ISSUE No XIII

📅 AUGUST 31, 2026

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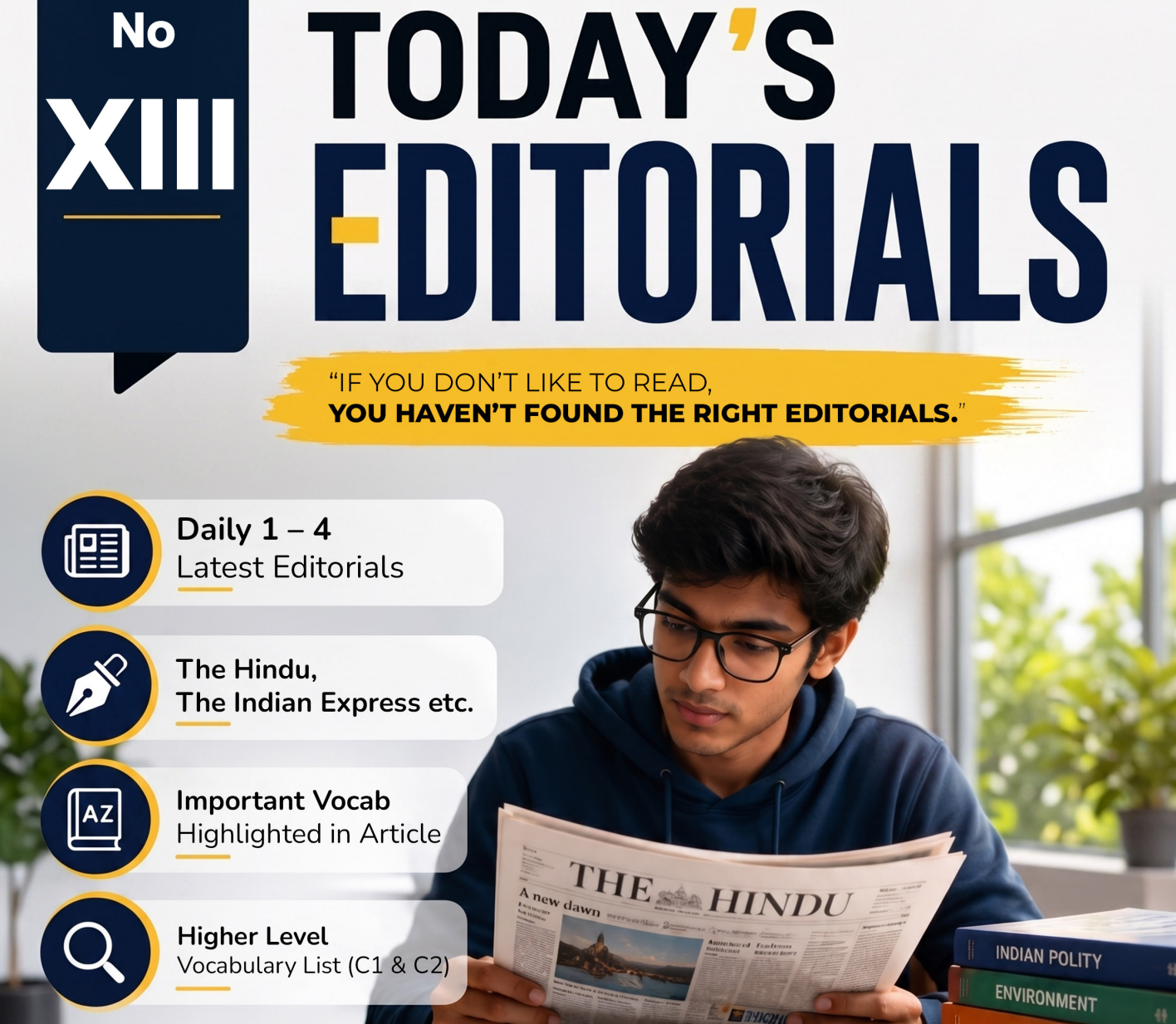

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ISSUE No XIII

📅 AUGUST 31, 2026

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> "No. I can survive well enough on my own— if given the proper reading material.
>
> -SARAH J. MAAS

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THE HINDU · HUMAN RIGHTS & INTERNATIONAL LAW

State of exception: On India, the UN CERD report

> India must heed international concerns on discrimination rather than evading accountability through administrative technicalities.

📅 August 31, 2026 · 3 min read · DAILY EDITORIAL READER

In its first review by the U.N. Committee on the Elimination of Racial Discrimination (CERD) since 2007, India has **elicited**[1] an expression of "grave concern" about reports of the law enforcement **apparatus**[2] **resorting to**[3] violence — physical and otherwise — against minority ethnic and ethno-religious groups, Dalits, and non-citizens over the years. The Committee also noted that India, which **ratified**[4] the International Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Racial Discrimination in 1968, has not provided detailed and updated information about the state's inquiries and **sanctions**[5] arising from allegations of such violence. While the government has told CERD that caste bias falls outside Article 1 of the convention because caste is not **synonymous with**[6] race, CERD has allowed all forms of discrimination based on inherited status. The Committee's concerns also span the practice of manual cleaning of sewers despite a law banning it; hate speech against, poor living conditions of, and the mass **refoulement**[7] of Rohingya Muslims; the mass **deprivation**[8] of citizenship via the National Register of Citizens; large-scale deletions from the Special Intensive Revisions of electoral rolls; the government's use of the FCRA, UAPA, AFSPA, and PMLA instruments to **hamper**[9] the work of civil society organisations; the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita not **expressly**[10] criminalising racist hate speech; and the Forest (Conservation) Amendment Act **exempting**[11] "national security" projects from consultative decision-making.

Given these issues and the **fragmented**[12] **recourse**[13] available, the lack of suitably **disaggregated**[14] data on **disenfranchised**[15] communities, including due to a much-delayed Census and the slow release of NCRB data, has **transcended**[16] the bounds of administrative **lethargy**[17] to actively **impeding**[18] independent checks of India's claims about fighting caste- and faith-based discrimination. In fact, India has been implementing "special measures" based on 2011 Census data, which could mask a **regression**[19] in the socioeconomic status of Scheduled Tribes and Adivasis. Together with the Global Alliance of National Human Rights Institutions recommending the downgrade of the NHRC last year, following the government appointing police officers to investigative roles and a lack of **pluralism**[20], CERD is effectively **stepping into a vacuum**[21]. The road ahead remains clear, from restoring the NHRC's independence and criminalising hate speech to supportive **affirmative action**[22], collecting and publishing **disaggregated**[14] data, and improving the transparency of the electoral roll revisions, and strengthening enforcement overall. But if the government's attempted use of a **technicality**[23] to keep the issues of 200 million Dalits a "domestic matter" and avoid international accountability — and its dismissal of CERD's concerns as politically motivated — is any guide, the task continues to fall to civil society to exert influence in multilateral **fora**[24] and sustain political, legal, and administrative resistance to government choices that **normalise**[25] India's sadly widespread culture of discrimination of all sorts.

Source: The Hindu · Published: August 31, 2026 12:20 AM IST

★ VOCABULARY 101

1. **elicited** (Verb) Evoked • प्राप्त किया / उत्पन्न किया
2. **apparatus** (Noun) Machinery • तंत्र / उपकरण
3. **resorting to** (Phrasal verb) Turning to • का सहारा लेना
4. **ratified** (Verb) Approved • पुष्टि की / अनुमोदित किया
5. **sanctions** (Noun) Penalties • दंडात्मक प्रतिबंध
6. **synonymous with** (Adjective) Equivalent to • के समानार्थक / पर्याय
7. **refoulement** (Noun) Forced return • शरणार्थियों का जबरन निष्कासन
8. **deprivation** (Noun) Loss • वंचन / अभाव
9. **hamper** (Verb) Hinder • बाधा डालना
10. **expressly** (Adverb) Explicitly • स्पष्ट रूप से
11. **exempting** (Verb) Excusing • छूट देना
12. **fragmented** (Adjective) Disjointed • खंडित / बिखरा हुआ
13. **recourse** (Noun) Remedy • उपाय / सहारा
14. **disaggregated** (Adjective) Itemised • पृथक-पृथक / उप-विभाजित
15. **disenfranchised** (Adjective) Marginalised • अधिकार-वंचित
16. **transcended** (Verb) Exceeded • से परे चला गया / पार कर गया
17. **lethargy** (Noun) Sluggishness • सुस्ती / आलस्य
18. **impeding** (Verb) Obstructing • अड़चन डालना
19. **regression** (Noun) Decline • पतन / अवनति
20. **pluralism** (Noun) Diversity • बहुलतावाद
21. **stepping into a vacuum** (Verb) Filling a void • रिक्तता को भरना
22. **affirmative action** (Noun) Positive discrimination • सकारात्मक कार्रवाई / आरक्षण
23. **technicality** (Noun) Formal detail • औपचारिक बारीकी / तकनीकी बहाना
24. **fora** (Noun) Platforms • मंच / सभाएँ
25. **normalise** (Verb) Make standard • सामान्य बनाना

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EDITORIAL ANALYSIS & VOCABULARY LAB

ARTICLE: State of exception: On India, the UN CERD report · THE HINDU · HUMAN RIGHTS & INTERNATIONAL LAW

EDITORIAL STANCE

CRITICAL

"fault-finding and warning"

EDITORIAL PERSPECTIVE

The author adopts a critical and admonitory tone to censure the Indian government's defensive posturing regarding systemic caste and religious discrimination. By highlighting the UN CERD findings alongside delayed census data and weakened human rights watchdogs, the editorial underscores an international regression in safeguarding minorities. The author ultimately urges civil society and international bodies to hold the state accountable against the normalisation of prejudice.

EDITORIAL VOCABULARY · 17 WORDS

01	**elicited** VERB NEUTRAL	प्राप्त किया / उत्पन्न किया Evoked or drew out a specific reaction, answer, or response from someone.	MEMORY HOOK Sounds like 'extract' + 'solicit' — drawing out a specific reaction or reply.	SYNONYMS • evoked • extracted • obtained	ANTONYMS • suppressed • repressed • concealed
02	**apparatus** NOUN NEUTRAL	तंत्र / उपकरण The technical equipment or complex organisational structure of a government or system.	MEMORY HOOK Apparatus sounds like 'appliances' or the internal mechanism running a system.	SYNONYMS • machinery • structure • organisation	ANTONYMS • disorganisation • individual • chaos
03	**ratified** VERB POSITIVE	पुष्टि की / अनुमोदित किया Gave formal consent or validation to a treaty or agreement, making it officially valid.	MEMORY HOOK 'Rate' + 'certified' — giving formal written approval to make an agreement valid.	SYNONYMS • endorsed • validated • confirmed	ANTONYMS • rejected • repudiated • annulled
04	**sanctions** NOUN NEGATIVE	दंडात्मक प्रतिबंध Threatened penalties or punitive measures imposed for disobeying a law or rule.	MEMORY HOOK Sanctions act like strict 'factions' enforcing punishments against violations.	SYNONYMS • penalties • punishments • embargoes	ANTONYMS • rewards • incentives • permissions
05	**deprivation** NOUN NEGATIVE	वंचन / अभाव The damaging lack of material benefits or fundamental rights considered essential.	MEMORY HOOK 'Deprive' means to strip away; deprivation is the state of being stripped of rights.	SYNONYMS • dispossession • divestment • denial	ANTONYMS • endowment • provision • enrichment
06	**hamper** VERB NEGATIVE	बाधा डालना To hinder, obstruct, or impede the progress or free movement of someone or something.	MEMORY HOOK Trying to run while carrying a heavy gift 'hamper' will slow down and block you.	SYNONYMS • impede • obstruct • thwart	ANTONYMS • facilitate • assist • expedite
07	**expressly** ADVERB NEUTRAL	स्पष्ट रूप से In an explicit, clear, and unambiguous manner for a specific purpose.	MEMORY HOOK Like an 'express' train moving directly and clearly to the destination without ambiguity.	SYNONYMS • explicitly • categorically • definitely	ANTONYMS • implicitly • vaguely • ambiguously
08	**exempting** VERB NEUTRAL	छूट देना Freeing or releasing a person or body from an obligation or liability imposed on others.	MEMORY HOOK 'Ex' (out) + 'empty' — leaving someone out of an obligation.	SYNONYMS • excusing • releasing • absolving	ANTONYMS • subjecting • obligating • binding
09	**fragmented** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	खंडित / बिखरा हुआ Broken down into small, disconnected, or isolated parts.	MEMORY HOOK Made of 'fragments' — broken pieces that are scattered and not unified.	SYNONYMS • disjointed • splintered • disconnected	ANTONYMS • unified • integrated • cohesive
10	**disaggregated** ADJECTIVE NEUTRAL	पृथक-पृथक / उप-विभाजित Separated into its constituent elements or smaller component sub-groups for detailed analysis.	MEMORY HOOK Opposite of 'aggregate' (total mass) — split into distinct component sub-categories.	SYNONYMS • itemised • segmented • differentiated	ANTONYMS • aggregated • consolidated • combined
11	**disenfranchised** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	अधिकार-वंचित Deprived of civil or legal rights, especially the right to vote or participate politically.	MEMORY HOOK 'Dis' (deprive) + 'franchise' (right to vote/rights) = stripped of constitutional power.	SYNONYMS • marginalised • disempowered • oppressed	ANTONYMS • enfranchised • empowered • privileged
12	**transcended** VERB NEUTRAL	से परे चला गया / पार कर गया Surpassed, exceeded, or went beyond the typical range or limits of something.	MEMORY HOOK 'Trans' (across) + 'ascend' (climb) — rising above or going beyond standard limits.	SYNONYMS • surpassed • exceeded • outstripped	ANTONYMS • trailed • succumbed • confined
13	**lethargy** NOUN NEGATIVE	सुस्ती / आलस्य A state of sluggishness, inactivity, or a lack of energy and administrative initiative.	MEMORY HOOK Sounds like 'lazy energy' — complete lack of enthusiasm or slow bureaucratic action.	SYNONYMS • inertia • torpor • sluggishness	ANTONYMS • vigour • alacrity • dynamism
14	**impeding** VERB NEGATIVE	अड़चन डालना Delaying or preventing someone or something by obstructing or hindering their progress.	MEMORY HOOK 'Im' + 'ped' (foot) — putting an obstacle around the foot to prevent movement.	SYNONYMS • obstructing • hindering • curbing	ANTONYMS • advancing • facilitating • promoting
15	**regression** NOUN NEGATIVE	पतन / अवनति A return to a previous, less advanced, or worse state of development.	MEMORY HOOK Opposite of 'progression' — moving backward into a worse condition.	SYNONYMS • deterioration • retrogression • decline	ANTONYMS • progression • advancement • improvement
16	**technicality** NOUN NEGATIVE	औपचारिक बारीकी / तकनीकी बहाना A petty point of law or a small formal rule used strategically to evade broader obligations.	MEMORY HOOK Focusing only on a small 'tech' or legal rule to evade the broader substantive reality.	SYNONYMS • formal detail • subtlety • quibble	ANTONYMS • substance • essence • core
17	**normalise** VERB NEGATIVE	सामान्य बनाना To cause something previously considered unacceptable or unusual to be regarded as standard.	MEMORY HOOK Making something abnormal or toxic seem 'normal' through repeated occurrence.	SYNONYMS • standardise • legitimise • institutionalise	ANTONYMS • stigmatise • denounce • aberrate

VOCAB LAB CONTINUED · STATE OF EXCEPTION: ON INDIA, THE UN CERD REPORT · PART 02

ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTIONS · 2 TERMS

01	**recourse** NOUN	उपाय / सहारा A source of help, legal remedy, or relief in a difficult or unjust situation.	MEMORY HOOK 'Re-course' = choosing an alternative course of action to seek legal help.	SYNONYMS • remedy • redress • resort	ANTONYMS • helplessness • deadlock • impasse
02	**pluralism** NOUN	बहुलतावाद A condition or system in which multiple distinct ethnic, religious, or political groups coexist.	MEMORY HOOK Root word 'plural' (many) — a system where many different groups coexist peacefully.	SYNONYMS • diversity • multiculturalism • coexistence	ANTONYMS • monism • uniformity • homogeneity

FIXED PREPOSITIONS · 2 TERMS

01	**resorting to** PHRASAL VERB	का सहारा लेना Turning to and adopting a particular, often undesirable, course of action when other options fail.	MEMORY HOOK When nothing else works, you visit the last 'resort' out of desperation.	SYNONYMS • turning to • employing • adopting	ANTONYMS • abstaining from • avoiding • shunning
02	**synonymous with** ADJECTIVE	के समानार्थक / पर्याय Having the same or nearly the same meaning; closely associated with another idea.	MEMORY HOOK 'Synonym' means the same meaning; hence, closely associated or interchangeable with.	SYNONYMS • equivalent to • interchangeable with • identical to	ANTONYMS • distinct from • opposite to • incompatible with

IDIOMS & PHRASES · 2 TERMS

01	**stepping into a vacuum** VERB	रिक्तता को भरना Taking charge, intervening, or asserting authority where there is an absence of control or leadership.	MEMORY HOOK A vacuum is empty space; stepping in means filling the absence of leadership or action.	SYNONYMS • filling the void • bridging the gap • taking over	ANTONYMS • withdrawing • vacating • retreating
02	**affirmative action** NOUN	सकारात्मक कार्रवाई / आरक्षण Policies and practices designed to favour members of a disadvantaged group who have suffered discrimination.	MEMORY HOOK 'Affirming' support through direct state 'action' to uplift historically suppressed classes.	SYNONYMS • positive discrimination • remedial policy • equal opportunity measu	ANTONYMS • discrimination • disenfranchisement • exclusion

FOREIGN WORDS · 2 TERMS

01	**refoulement** NOUN	शरणार्थियों का जबरन निष्कासन The forcible return of refugees or asylum seekers to a country where they are likely to face persecution.	MEMORY HOOK Sounds like 'return through foul means' — forcibly driving refugees back to danger.	SYNONYMS • forced repatriation • deportation • expulsion	ANTONYMS • asylum • shelter • protection
02	**fora** NOUN	मंच / सभाएँ Public meeting places, assemblies, or media outlets for open discussion and debate.	MEMORY HOOK Latin plural of 'forum' — multiple platforms or arenas for open debate.	SYNONYMS • forums • platforms • arenas	ANTONYMS • seclusion • isolation • privacy

READ NEXT EDITORIAL · PAGE 06
Drawn to defeat: On India's chances in the ICC World Test Championship →

THE HINDU · SPORTS / TEST CRICKET

Drawn to defeat: On India's chances in the ICC World Test Championship

> India's drawn series in Sri Lanka complicates their World Test Championship final qualification scenario.

📅 August 31, 2026 · 2 min read · DAILY EDITORIAL READER

This was a triumph that **ironically**[1] suffered the after-effects of a loss. India's 1-0 series victory in the two-Test outing recently in Sri Lanka, in normal circumstances, would have been seen as a positive. However, in the race for key points in the ICC World Test Championship (WTC) cycle, the ideal India-centric result would have been a **clean sweep**[2] at 2-0. But with Dhananjaya de Silva's men **thwarting**[3] India's **bid for**[4] a win in the second Test at Colombo's Sinhalese Sports Club Ground, and forcing a draw, the visitors continue to occupy the fifth slot in the WTC rankings. It is a position one below Bangladesh after the eastern neighbour secured a 1-1 draw against Australia in the series **Down Under**[5]. If a WTC final **berth**[6] has to be secured then India has to do extremely well away against New Zealand and at home against Australia, and then hope that the **permutations**[7] **cropping up**[8] will be favourable. Shubman Gill's men find themselves in this **piquant**[9] situation due to their **vulnerability**[10] at home, having lost a Test series to South Africa last year. The transition **angst**[11] within the Indian unit is yet to **abate**[12] following the exit of R. Ashwin, Virat Kohli and Rohit Sharma. Slowly, new heroes are emerging and the results could improve.

Stepping into the Emerald Isle and **hamstrung**[13] by the injured Jasprit Bumrah's absence, India did its homework. A warm-up fixture was won, while some of its players had earlier **turned out**[14] for India A against Sri Lanka A and were ready. When the series commenced with the first Test at **picturesque**[15] Galle, India led from the front and won by 165 runs to secure a 1-0 lead. Devdutt Padikkal's 167 and 44 led the run charts and most importantly it also meant that the critical number three spot in the batting order had found an **apt**[16] occupant for now. This is the same position that in the past had featured **pedigreed**[17] men such as Dilip Vengsarkar, Rahul Dravid and Cheteshwar Pujara. Left-arm spinner Manav Suthar too did well and his classical mode is a **throwback**[18] to a gentle past. Sri Lanka's brief resistance **hinged on**[19] Sonal Dinusha, who registered a ton. Soon he would become an **immovable**[20] personality at the batting crease and India learnt it the hard way at Colombo. His twin hundreds helped Sri Lanka erase the **ignominy**[21] of suffering a follow-on and also survive a tense final day to **wrest**[22] a draw. The conclusion felt like a victory for the host and India is now placed in a must-win corner in its future Tests.

Source: The Hindu · Published: August 31, 2026 12:10 AM IST

★ VOCABULARY 101

1. **Ironically** (Adverb) Paradoxically • व्यंग्यात्मक रूप से / विडंबना से
2. **Clean sweep** (Noun) Complete victory • पूरी जीत / सूपड़ा साफ़
3. **Thwarting** (Verb) Preventing • नाकाम करना / विफल करना
4. **Bid for** (Noun) Attempt at • प्रयास करना / दावेदारी
5. **Down Under** (Adverb) Australia/New Zealand • ऑस्ट्रेलिया या न्यूज़ीलैंड
6. **Berth** (Noun) Place/Spot • स्थान / जगह
7. **Permutations** (Noun) Combinations • संभावित गणनाएँ / फेरबदल
8. **Cropping up** (Verb) Arising • अचानक प्रकट होना
9. **Piquant** (Adjective) Tricky/Provocative • दिलचस्प लेकिन पेचीदा / तीखा
10. **Vulnerability** (Noun) Weakness • संवेदनशीलता / भेद्यता
11. **Angst** (Noun) Deep anxiety • गहरी चिंता / बेचैनी
12. **Abate** (Verb) Lessen • कम होना / घटना
13. **Hamstrung** (Verb) Crippled/Restricted • बाधित / लाचार बना दिया
14. **Turned out** (Verb) Appeared/Played • मैदान में उतरे / भाग लिया
15. **Picturesque** (Adjective) Scenically beautiful • चित्रमय / दर्शनीय
16. **Apt** (Adjective) Suitable • उचित / सर्वथा योग्य
17. **Pedigreed** (Adjective) Distinguished • प्रतिष्ठित / उच्च कुल या पृष्ठभूमि वाला
18. **Throwback** (Noun) Reminder of past • पुरानी याद ताज़ा करने वाला / पूर्व लक्षण
19. **Hinged on** (Verb) Depended on • पर निर्भर होना
20. **Immovable** (Adjective) Unshakeable • अटल / अविचल
21. **Ignominy** (Noun) Shame/Disgrace • बदनामी / अपमान
22. **Wrest** (Verb) Snatch/Extract • छीन लेना / संघर्ष करके हासिल करना

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EDITORIAL ANALYSIS & VOCABULARY LAB

ARTICLE: Drawn to defeat: On India's chances in the ICC World Test Championship · THE HINDU · SPORTS / TEST CRICKET

EDITORIAL STANCE

ANALYTICAL

"evaluating outcomes and challenges"

EDITORIAL PERSPECTIVE

The author evaluates India's 1-0 series win in Sri Lanka through the lens of the World Test Championship points table, where dropping a match acts as a tactical setback. By examining squad transitions and missed opportunities to sweep the series, the piece underlines the heightened pressure on the team. It concludes that India must deliver flawless performances in upcoming tours to remain in contention for the final.

EDITORIAL VOCABULARY · 13 WORDS

01	**Ironically** ADVERB NEUTRAL	व्यंग्यात्मक रूप से / विडंबना से In a manner that happens contrary to expectations and often seems wryly amusing or contradictory.	MEMORY HOOK Think of 'Irony'—when what happens is the complete opposite of what you reasonably expect.	SYNONYMS • paradoxically • incongruously • unexpectedly	ANTONYMS • predictably • expectedly • naturally
02	**Thwarting** VERB NEGATIVE	नाकाम करना / विफल करना Preventing someone from accomplishing a purpose or stopping an effort from succeeding.	MEMORY HOOK Sounds like 'throw water' on someone's fiery plan to extinguish and spoil it.	SYNONYMS • foiling • frustrating • impeding	ANTONYMS • aiding • assisting • facilitating
03	**Berth** NOUN POSITIVE	स्थान / जगह A secure position, spot, or place gained in a competition, ranking, or organisation.	MEMORY HOOK Like booking a train 'berth' (sleeping spot) gives you a guaranteed seat/position in the tournament.	SYNONYMS • slot • place • position	ANTONYMS • exclusion • elimination • rejection
04	**Permutations** NOUN NEUTRAL	संभावित गणनाएँ / फेरबदल Several different ways in which a set of things can be arranged, ordered, or combined.	MEMORY HOOK Think of maths: 'permutations and combinations'—all the different variations of possible scenarios.	SYNONYMS • variations • configurations • combinations	ANTONYMS • uniformity • sameness • invariance
05	**Piquant** ADJECTIVE NEUTRAL	दिलचस्प लेकिन पेचीदा / तीखा Pleasantly or provocatively stimulating to the mind; uniquely challenging or intriguing in nature.	MEMORY HOOK Think of a 'pickled' chili that gives a sharp, provocative flavour—here meaning an engaging, tricky situation.	SYNONYMS • intriguing • fascinating • stimulating	ANTONYMS • mundane • insipid • uninspiring
06	**Vulnerability** NOUN NEGATIVE	संवेदनशीलता / भेद्यता The quality or state of being exposed to the possibility of being attacked or harmed, either physically or emotionally.	MEMORY HOOK From Latin 'vulnus' (wound)—a state where one is easily wounded or attacked.	SYNONYMS • susceptibility • fragility • weakness	ANTONYMS • invulnerability • resilience • fortitude
07	**Abate** VERB POSITIVE	कम होना / घटना To become less intense, severe, or widespread; to diminish in degree.	MEMORY HOOK Think of 'rebate'—a rebate reduces the price, while abate reduces the intensity.	SYNONYMS • subside • diminish • dwindle	ANTONYMS • intensify • escalate • surge
08	**Hamstrung** VERB NEGATIVE	बाधित / लाचार बना दिया Severely restricted the efficiency, movement, or effectiveness of someone or something.	MEMORY HOOK If your 'hamstring' muscle is torn, you are disabled and completely unable to run.	SYNONYMS • handicapped • hindered • incapacitated	ANTONYMS • empowered • aided • liberated
09	**Picturesque** ADJECTIVE POSITIVE	चित्रमय / दर्शनीय Visually attractive in a charming, scenic, and quaint manner suitable for a painting.	MEMORY HOOK Looks exactly like a 'picture' that is so charming you want to frame it.	SYNONYMS • scenic • charming • panoramic	ANTONYMS • unsightly • grotesque • drab
10	**Apt** ADJECTIVE POSITIVE	उचित / सर्वथा योग्य Appropriate, fitting, or well-suited to the given circumstances.	MEMORY HOOK Think of 'aptitude'—someone who has the right ability is very 'apt' (suitable) for the role.	SYNONYMS • appropriate • fitting • suitable	ANTONYMS • inapt • unsuitable • inappropriate
11	**Pedigreed** ADJECTIVE POSITIVE	प्रतिष्ठित / उच्च कुल या पृष्ठभूमि वाला Having an established, distinguished background, lineage, or proven record of excellence.	MEMORY HOOK Think of royal pedigree pets that have an immaculate, proven family record.	SYNONYMS • distinguished • illustrious • accomplished	ANTONYMS • unheralded • undistinguished • ignoble
12	**Ignominy** NOUN NEGATIVE	बदनामी / अपमान Public shame, disgrace, or deep humiliation resulting from poor conduct or defeat.	MEMORY HOOK Ig (negative) + nom (name) -> spoiling your good name brings public disgrace.	SYNONYMS • humiliation • disgrace • opprobrium	ANTONYMS • honour • prestige • glory
13	**Wrest** VERB POSITIVE	छीन लेना / संघर्ष करके हासिल करना To forcibly pull or obtain something from someone's grasp through intense effort or struggle.	MEMORY HOOK Sounds like 'wrestle'—you have to wrestle hard with an opponent to pull the prize away.	SYNONYMS • snatch • seize • extract	ANTONYMS • relinquish • concede • yield

VOCAB LAB CONTINUED · DRAWN TO DEFEAT: ON INDIA'S CHANCES IN THE ICC WORLD TEST CHAMPIONSHIP · PART 02

ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTIONS · 2 TERMS

01	**Throwback** NOUN	पुरानी याद ताज़ा करने वाला / पूर्व लक्षण A person or thing that bears a striking resemblance to something from an earlier era.	MEMORY HOOK Literally something that 'throws' your mind 'back' to an earlier era.	SYNONYMS • reversion • reminiscence • atavism	ANTONYMS • innovation • modernity • novelty
02	**Immovable** ADJECTIVE	अटल / अविचल Unable or refusing to be moved; steadfastly resilient against pressure.	MEMORY HOOK Im (not) + movable = completely unable to be moved or displaced by the opposition.	SYNONYMS • unshakeable • resolute • unyielding	ANTONYMS • flexible • pliant • wavering

FIXED PREPOSITIONS · 2 TERMS

01	**Bid for** NOUN	प्रयास करना / दावेदारी An earnest attempt or effort made to achieve, secure, or win something.	MEMORY HOOK In an auction, your 'bid for' an item is your serious attempt to win it.	SYNONYMS • attempt at • pursuit of • endeavour towards	ANTONYMS • surrender of • withdrawal from • renunciation of
02	**Hinged on** VERB	पर निर्भर होना Depended entirely on a particular person, condition, or factor to succeed.	MEMORY HOOK A door completely relies and turns on its metal 'hinge' to open or close.	SYNONYMS • depended on • pivoted on • rested upon	ANTONYMS • detached from • freed from • independent of

PHRASAL VERBS · 2 TERMS

01	**Cropping up** VERB	अचानक प्रकट होना Appearing, happening, or arising unexpectedly or without advance notice.	MEMORY HOOK Like farm 'crops' suddenly growing out of the soil overnight without being noticed.	SYNONYMS • emerging • surfacing • materialising	ANTONYMS • disappearing • vanishing • subsiding
02	**Turned out** VERB	मैदान में उतरे / भाग लिया Took part in a sporting match or assembled for an event.	MEMORY HOOK You 'turn' around and step 'out' into the open stadium ground to play.	SYNONYMS • participated • featured • represented	ANTONYMS • withdrew • abstained • sat out

IDIOMS & PHRASES · 2 TERMS

01	**Clean sweep** NOUN	पूरी जीत / सूपड़ा साफ़ A decisive victory in which one contestant or team wins all available matches, contests, or prizes.	MEMORY HOOK Imagine a broom completely 'sweeping' every single crumb away—leaving nothing behind for the opponent.	SYNONYMS • whitewash • total triumph • landslide victory	ANTONYMS • total defeat • whitewash defeat • rout
02	**Down Under** ADVERB	ऑस्ट्रेलिया या न्यूज़ीलैंड An informal term referring to Australia and New Zealand due to their position in the southern hemisphere.	MEMORY HOOK On a traditional world globe, Australia is positioned all the way 'down under' the equator.	SYNONYMS • Australasia • Antipodes • Oceania	ANTONYMS

FOREIGN WORDS · 1 TERMS

01	**Angst** NOUN	गहरी चिंता / बेचैनी A deep feeling of persistent anxiety, dread, or apprehension, often about condition and change.	MEMORY HOOK Sounds like 'anxious' + 'agony'—a deep state of internal worry about uncertain transitions.	SYNONYMS • apprehension • trepidation • unease	ANTONYMS • serenity • calmness • tranquility

READ NEXT EDITORIAL · PAGE 09
As glaciers melt, prepare for a Himalayan challenge →

THE INDIAN EXPRESS · ENVIRONMENTAL POLICY & CLIMATE CHANGE

As glaciers melt, prepare for a Himalayan challenge

> Urgent regional cooperation and resilient infrastructure are essential to mitigate escalating Himalayan glacial disasters.

📅 August 31, 2026 · 2 min read · DAILY EDITORIAL READER

The Himalayan mountain system is the ecological **mainstay**[1] of large parts of the Indian Subcontinent. It is the **wellspring**[2] of rivers and shapes the monsoon. Its forests support biodiversity, and the region is home to several pilgrimage centres. However, the range has become increasingly **fragile**[3] in recent years. The **mounting**[4] toll of the flash floods that struck Nepal last week after a glacier collapse near the country's border with China sent torrents of water down the Bhote Koshi River is a grim reminder of the region's **precarity**[5]. It **underscores**[6] how a disturbance in higher altitudes can swiftly become a downstream **catastrophe**[7].

Several studies, including IPCC reports, have documented the **retreat**[8] of glaciers in the rapidly warming Himalaya. The meltwater accumulates in glacial lakes, many of which are held back by unstable dams of boulders. These lakes can suddenly burst, sending enormous volumes of water and debris down narrow valleys. Landslides, avalanches and **erratic**[9] rainfall can trigger **cascading**[10] events. The Nepal disaster appears to have involved an ice-and-rock avalanche. It is not an isolated incident. A glacial lake outburst in Nepal's Everest region led to massive flooding two years ago. A 2021 study by scientists from IIT Roorkee, IISc Bengaluru, University of Dayton, University of Graz, and the Universities of Zurich and Geneva **flagged**[11] instability around South Lhonak Lake in Sikkim. The warning went largely **unheeded**[12] — the lake burst two years later, killing at least 50 people.

The expansion of roads, hydropower schemes and tourism facilities in the valleys has added another layer of risk. Such projects are necessary for livelihoods, energy security and connectivity. But infrastructure development must **factor in**[13] the **idiosyncrasies**[14] of mountain ecology. Environmental assessments must account for the **cumulative**[15] risks from infrastructure projects, while construction standards must reflect the requirements of an unstable landscape. Glaciers need continuous monitoring, with information shared across borders because Himalayan rivers and hazards do not respect political boundaries. Some efforts are **underway**[16]. India is **accelerating**[17] early-warning systems for the region's lakes, while Nepal and China share information on Himalayan ecology. But last week's disaster is a **stark**[18] reminder of how much more needs to be done. The Bhote Koshi's warning system, designed to track the gradual movement of glacial water, could not detect the sudden **surge**[19] of debris. The experience of Switzerland, where advance monitoring and evacuation helped limit casualties after a glacier collapse destroyed much of the Blatten region in 2025, offers useful lessons. The geology of the Alps and Himalaya is, of course, vastly different. Even then, the **salience**[20] of sharing expertise across mountainous regions cannot be **understated**[21]. These **imperatives**[22] must now be integrated into technology transfer programmes under climate pacts.

Source: The Indian Express · Published: August 31, 2026 06:00 AM IST

★ VOCABULARY 101

1. **mainstay** (Noun) backbone • मुख्य आधार
2. **wellspring** (Noun) fountainhead • मूल स्रोत
3. **fragile** (Adjective) delicate • नाज़ुक / भंगुर
4. **mounting** (Adjective) increasing • बढ़ता हुआ
5. **precarity** (Noun) insecurity • डांवाडोल स्थिति / अनिश्चितता
6. **underscores** (Verb) emphasises • रेखांकित करना / बल देना
7. **catastrophe** (Noun) disaster • महाविपत्ति / तबाही
8. **retreat** (Noun) shrinkage • पीछे हटना / सिकुड़ना
9. **erratic** (Adjective) unpredictable • अनियमित / अप्रत्याशित
10. **cascading** (Adjective) successive • सिलसिलेवार / एक के बाद एक
11. **flagged** (Verb) signalled • चेतावनी देना / चिह्नित करना
12. **unheeded** (Adjective) ignored • अनसुना / उपेक्षित
13. **factor in** (Verb) include • शामिल करना / ध्यान में रखना
14. **idiosyncrasies** (Noun) peculiarities • विशिष्ट लक्षण / विचित्रताएँ
15. **cumulative** (Adjective) accumulative • संचयी / कुल मिलाकर
16. **underway** (Adjective) in progress • प्रगति पर / जारी
17. **accelerating** (Verb) speeding up • गति तेज़ करना
18. **stark** (Adjective) unpleasant and clear • कठोर / बिल्कुल स्पष्ट
19. **surge** (Noun) sudden rush • अचानक उफान / तीव्र बहाव
20. **salience** (Noun) prominence • प्रमुखता / महत्ता
21. **understated** (Verb) downplayed • कम आंकना
22. **imperatives** (Noun) necessities • अनिवार्य प्राथमिकताएँ / बाध्यताएँ

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EDITORIAL ANALYSIS & VOCABULARY LAB

ARTICLE: As glaciers melt, prepare for a Himalayan challenge · THE INDIAN EXPRESS · ENVIRONMENTAL POLICY & CLIMATE CHANGE

EDITORIAL STANCE

ADMONITORY / CAUTIONARY

"warning of mounting dangers"

EDITORIAL PERSPECTIVE

The author adopts a cautionary and urgent tone to emphasize the escalating vulnerability of the Himalayan ecosystem due to rapid glacial melting. By citing recent catastrophic flash floods in Nepal and Sikkim, the editorial highlights the dangerous lag in institutional response and the hazards posed by unbridled infrastructure expansion. It strongly advocates for integrated transboundary early-warning networks, strict ecological building standards, and cross-border scientific collaboration.

EDITORIAL VOCABULARY · 16 WORDS

01	**mainstay** NOUN POSITIVE	मुख्य आधार A chief foundation or essential supporting component of a system.	MEMORY HOOK MAIN + STAY = the main pillar that makes a structure stay upright.	SYNONYMS • cornerstone • pillar • bulwark	ANTONYMS • hindrance • destabiliser • appendage
02	**fragile** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	नाज़ुक / भंगुर Easily damaged, broken, or disrupted; vulnerable to harm.	MEMORY HOOK Rhymes with 'agile'; fragile things break easily when handled without care.	SYNONYMS • vulnerable • precarious • brittle	ANTONYMS • resilient • robust • durable
03	**mounting** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	बढ़ता हुआ Gradually growing larger in quantity, extent, or intensity.	MEMORY HOOK Like climbing a MOUNTain, mounting numbers keep going higher and higher.	SYNONYMS • escalating • accumulating • intensifying	ANTONYMS • diminishing • dwindling • subsiding
04	**underscores** VERB NEUTRAL	रेखांकित करना / बल देना Stresses, emphasizes, or highlights the importance of a fact.	MEMORY HOOK Drawing an 'under-score' (underline) beneath a sentence to emphasize it.	SYNONYMS • accentuates • underlines • reinforces	ANTONYMS • downplays • belittles • glosses over
05	**catastrophe** NOUN NEGATIVE	महाविपत्ति / तबाही An event causing great and often sudden damage or suffering.	MEMORY HOOK CATA (downwards) + STROPHE (turn) = an extreme downturn causing great ruin.	SYNONYMS • calamity • cataclysm • devastation	ANTONYMS • godsend • boon • triumph
06	**retreat** NOUN NEGATIVE	पीछे हटना / सिकुड़ना The process of receding or diminishing in size or coverage over time.	MEMORY HOOK Re-TREAT means stepping back or receding from a previous front.	SYNONYMS • recession • regression • shrinkage	ANTONYMS • advance • expansion • progression
07	**erratic** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	अनियमित / अप्रत्याशित Not even or regular in pattern or movement; wildly unpredictable.	MEMORY HOOK Sounds like 'error'; behaviour full of errors is erratic and inconsistent.	SYNONYMS • capricious • unstable • fluctuating	ANTONYMS • consistent • steady • predictable
08	**cascading** ADJECTIVE NEUTRAL	सिलसिलेवार / एक के बाद एक Passing down or triggering a sequence of successive stages or consequences.	MEMORY HOOK Like a waterfall (cascade) where one drop pushes the next in a sequence.	SYNONYMS • sequential • domino-like • consequential	ANTONYMS • isolated • independent • discrete
09	**flagged** VERB NEUTRAL	चेतावनी देना / चिह्नित करना Identified or drew attention to information for consideration or caution.	MEMORY HOOK Waving a red flag to draw attention to an impending danger.	SYNONYMS • highlighted • earmarked • indicated	ANTONYMS • overlooked • concealed • ignored
10	**unheeded** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	अनसुना / उपेक्षित Heard or noticed but completely disregarded or not acted upon.	MEMORY HOOK Un- (not) + Heeded (paid attention to) = disregarded.	SYNONYMS • disregarded • neglected • dismissed	ANTONYMS • heeded • observed • respected
11	**cumulative** ADJECTIVE NEUTRAL	संचयी / कुल मिलाकर Increasing or building up by successive additions over time.	MEMORY HOOK Relate to 'accumulate'; things that add up step by step.	SYNONYMS • aggregate • collective • amassed	ANTONYMS • fractional • individual • isolated
12	**accelerating** VERB POSITIVE	गति तेज़ करना Increasing the rate, tempo, or speed of an operation or process.	MEMORY HOOK Pressing the accelerator pedal makes a vehicle move faster.	SYNONYMS • expediting • quickening • hastening	ANTONYMS • decelerating • retarding • delaying
13	**stark** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	कठोर / बिल्कुल स्पष्ट Severe, blunt, or harsh in appearance or reality; unmistakably obvious.	MEMORY HOOK Think of 'Stark' reality—bare, cold, and impossible to hide.	SYNONYMS • uncompromising • grim • blunt	ANTONYMS • mild • vague • subtle
14	**surge** NOUN NEGATIVE	अचानक उफान / तीव्र बहाव A sudden and powerful forward or upward movement.	MEMORY HOOK SURGE sounds like 'submerge' — a sudden water surge can submerge low areas.	SYNONYMS • spate • deluge • rush	ANTONYMS • ebb • retreat • subsidence
15	**salience** NOUN POSITIVE	प्रमुखता / महत्ता The quality of being particularly noticeable, important, or prominent.	MEMORY HOOK A 'salient' feature stands out prominently from the rest.	SYNONYMS • prominence • significance • conspicuousness	ANTONYMS • inconsequentiality • insignificance • obscurity
16	**understated** VERB NEUTRAL	कम आंकना Described or represented as being smaller or less important than it actually is.	MEMORY HOOK To 'under-state' is to state something as less than its true magnitude.	SYNONYMS • minimised • downplayed • undervalued	ANTONYMS • exaggerated • overstated • magnified

VOCAB LAB CONTINUED · AS GLACIERS MELT, PREPARE FOR A HIMALAYAN CHALLENGE · PART 02

ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTIONS · 4 TERMS

01	**wellspring** NOUN	मूल स्रोत An abundant source or continuous origin of something.	MEMORY HOOK A 'spring' of water from a deep 'well' serves as the ultimate source of a river.	SYNONYMS • provenance • origin • cradle	ANTONYMS • drain • sink • terminus
02	**precarity** NOUN	डांवाडोल स्थिति / अनिश्चितता A state of persistent danger, instability, or uncertainty.	MEMORY HOOK Think 'PRE-CARE-ITY' — a situation so risky that you must take care beforehand.	SYNONYMS • perilousness • instability • hazardousness	ANTONYMS • solidity • security • steadfastness
03	**idiosyncrasies** NOUN	विशिष्ट लक्षण / विचित्रताएँ Distinctive or unique characteristics peculiar to an entity or environment.	MEMORY HOOK IDIO (distinct/personal) + SYNCRASY (mixing) = distinct, unique characteristics.	SYNONYMS • eccentricities • peculiarities • quirks	ANTONYMS • conformities • commonalities • uniformities
04	**imperatives** NOUN	अनिवार्य प्राथमिकताएँ / बाध्यताएँ Essential, urgent, or indispensable obligations that require immediate action.	MEMORY HOOK It is 'imperative' (vital) that you follow compulsory rules.	SYNONYMS • prerequisites • necessities • exigencies	ANTONYMS • options • trivialities • luxuries

PHRASAL VERBS · 1 TERMS

01	**factor in** VERB	शामिल करना / ध्यान में रखना To include a particular fact or circumstance when making an assessment or plan.	MEMORY HOOK Include every single 'factor' in your calculation.	SYNONYMS • incorporate • allow for • take into account	ANTONYMS • exclude • omit • discount

IDIOMS & PHRASES · 1 TERMS

01	**underway** ADJECTIVE	प्रगति पर / जारी Currently in progress, happening, or being carried out.	MEMORY HOOK The ship is 'under its way', meaning it has started its journey.	SYNONYMS • ongoing • afoot • in motion	ANTONYMS • halted • stalled • terminated

READ NEXT EDITORIAL · PAGE 12
Meta's US deal redraws line of accountability →

THE INDIAN EXPRESS · TECHNOLOGY & DIGITAL REGULATION

Meta's US deal redraws line of accountability

> US regulatory settlement mandates platform accountability rather than relying solely on parental vigilance.

📅 August 31, 2026 · 2 min read · DAILY EDITORIAL READER

The settlement between Meta and 29 US states over the harm its platforms can cause children is a **veiled**[1] **admission**[2] of a truth that Big Tech has spent years resisting: That these platforms are built to capture attention, and therefore have a **responsibility towards**[3] how they affect young users. Meta will pay up to $18 billion over a decade and introduce a series of restrictions on Facebook and Instagram, including two-hour daily limits for under-18 users, a midnight-to-6-am curfew, stronger age verification mechanisms, default safety settings, and reduced notifications during school hours. The company has denied wrongdoing, and the settlement **leaves untouched**[4] some of the more fundamental questions about personalised recommendations and the advertising-driven business model. Even so, it marks a significant step towards recognising that children's safety can no longer be treated as a matter of self-control or parental **vigilance**[5], that product design itself should come under regulatory **scrutiny**[6].

That is the direction that global regulation has been increasingly **moving towards**[7]. There is a recognition of the fact that these platforms are built to make stopping difficult — the **infinite scroll**[8] ensures recommendations continuously supply the next piece of content; notifications and other "**hooks**[9]" are designed to bring users back; likes, streaks and personalised feeds turn attention into a measurable **commodity**[10]. They are features of an engagement economy in which time spent is valuable because attention can be **monetised**[11]. Technology companies have long pushed much of the **responsibility towards**[3] parents who must monitor screen time and users who must exercise self-control. The new **curbs**[13] begin to **move responsibility upstream**[14], towards the companies that build and profit from systems **engineered**[15] to resist **disengagement**[16].

The American settlement offers a useful model for India as it **contemplates**[17] regulation around children's social-media usage. A system **reliant solely on**[18] parental supervision will inevitably leave protection **uneven**[19], depending on digital literacy, time, and household resources. Regulation should instead ask harder questions of the platforms: Why should an engagement-maximising feed be the default for a child? Why should a young user have to **opt out of**[20] personalisation rather than have a safer feed by default? And why should the **burden**[21] of resisting an infinite stream of content fall on the user rather than on the company that created it? Meta's US deal could mark the beginning of a broader effort to **redraw the boundaries of**[22] responsibility.

Source: The Indian Express · Published: August 31, 2026 06:05 AM IST

★ VOCABULARY 101

1. **veiled** (Adjective) disguised • प्रच्छन्न / छिपा हुआ
2. **admission** (Noun) acknowledgement • स्वीकारोक्ति
3. **responsibility towards** (Phrase) duty to • के प्रति उत्तरदायित्व
4. **leaves untouched** (Phrase) ignores • अनछुआ छोड़ देना / अनदेखा करना
5. **vigilance** (Noun) watchfulness • सतर्कता / निगरानी
6. **scrutiny** (Noun) inspection • बारीक जांच / छानबीन
7. **moving towards** (Phrasal verb) advancing to • की दिशा में आगे बढ़ना
8. **infinite scroll** (Noun) endless feed • अंतहीन स्क्रॉलिंग प्रणाली
9. **hooks** (Noun) traps • आकर्षक फंदे / प्रलोभन
10. **commodity** (Noun) trade product • पण्य वस्तु / व्यापारिक उत्पाद
11. **monetised** (Verb) commercialised • मुद्रीकृत / धनोपार्जन में परिवर्तित
12. **pushed towards** (Phrasal verb) shifted onto • की ओर धकेलना / थोपना
13. **curbs** (Noun) restrictions • अंकुश / पाबंदियां
14. **move responsibility upstream** (Phrase) tackle source • जिम्मेदारी को मूल स्रोत पर स्थानांतरित करना
15. **engineered** (Verb) designed • योजनाबद्ध रूप से निर्मित
16. **disengagement** (Noun) detachment • अलगाव / अलग होने की प्रक्रिया
17. **contemplates** (Verb) considers • विचार करना / चिंतन करना
18. **reliant solely on** (Phrase) dependent only on • पूरी तरह से पर निर्भर
19. **uneven** (Adjective) inconsistent • असमान / असंगत
20. **opt out of** (Phrasal verb) withdraw from • से बाहर निकलने का विकल्प चुनना
21. **burden** (Noun) heavy load • बोझ / उत्तरदायित्व का भार
22. **redraw the boundaries of** (Phrase) redefine limits of • की सीमाओं को पुनर्परिभाषित करना

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EDITORIAL ANALYSIS & VOCABULARY LAB

ARTICLE: Meta's US deal redraws line of accountability · THE INDIAN EXPRESS · TECHNOLOGY & DIGITAL REGULATION

EDITORIAL STANCE

ANALYTICAL

"examining issues methodically"

EDITORIAL PERSPECTIVE

The author critically evaluates Meta's multi-billion-dollar legal settlement with US states, arguing that algorithmic feeds and monetised attention structurally foster juvenile addiction. By highlighting that individual self-control cannot counter addictive design, the editorial advocates for robust, platform-centric regulation in developing markets like India.

EDITORIAL VOCABULARY · 11 WORDS

01	**veiled** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	प्रच्छन्न / छिपा हुआ Expressed in an indirect, partially concealed, or disguised manner.	MEMORY HOOK Think of a bridal 'veil' that covers or conceals the face from direct view.	SYNONYMS • disguised • masked • covert	ANTONYMS • overt • explicit • unconcealed
02	**admission** NOUN NEUTRAL	स्वीकारोक्ति A statement acknowledging the truth of something, often done reluctantly.	MEMORY HOOK When you 'admit' an error into your mind, you make an admission.	SYNONYMS • acknowledgement • concession • confession	ANTONYMS • denial • refusal • repudiation
03	**vigilance** NOUN POSITIVE	सतर्कता / निगरानी The state of keeping careful watch for possible dangers or difficulties.	MEMORY HOOK A 'vigilante' stays awake at night with keen 'vigilance' to watch for danger.	SYNONYMS • watchfulness • alertness • circumspection	ANTONYMS • negligence • carelessness • inattention
04	**scrutiny** NOUN NEUTRAL	बारीक जांच / छानबीन Critical observation, thorough examination, or close surveillance.	MEMORY HOOK To screw in a tiny part, you need close 'scrutiny' and sharp observation.	SYNONYMS • inspection • investigation • examination	ANTONYMS • neglect • oversight • inattention
05	**hooks** NOUN NEGATIVE	आकर्षक फंदे / प्रलोभन Features or techniques deliberately designed to captivate and trap attention.	MEMORY HOOK A fishing 'hook' catches the fish by luring it with attractive bait.	SYNONYMS • enticements • snares • attractions	ANTONYMS • deterrents • repellants • disincentives
06	**monetised** VERB NEUTRAL	मुद्रीकृत / धनोपार्जन में परिवर्तित Converted an activity, asset, or audience engagement into commercial profit.	MEMORY HOOK Convert into 'money' -> 'monetise'.	SYNONYMS • commercialised • capitalised • profitised	ANTONYMS • decommercialised • demonetised • subsidised
07	**curbs** NOUN NEUTRAL	अंकुश / पाबंदियां Checks, restraints, or official limits placed upon an activity or behaviour.	MEMORY HOOK A road 'curb' stops vehicles from driving off the street, acting as a restraint.	SYNONYMS • restraints • restrictions • constraints	ANTONYMS • incentives • allowances • freedoms
08	**engineered** VERB NEUTRAL	योजनाबद्ध रूप से निर्मित Deliberately designed, constructed, or manipulated to achieve a specific result.	MEMORY HOOK An 'engineer' deliberately crafts and plans complex structures with precision.	SYNONYMS • designed • contrived • manufactured	ANTONYMS • improvised • unplanned • spontaneous
09	**contemplates** VERB NEUTRAL	विचार करना / चिंतन करना Looks at thoughtfully or considers an action thoroughly over a period of time.	MEMORY HOOK Sitting quietly in a 'temple' to deeply meditate and 'contemplate' life choices.	SYNONYMS • deliberates • ponders • envisages	ANTONYMS • ignores • disregards • rejects
10	**uneven** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	असमान / असंगत Not uniform, fair, or well-balanced across different segments or groups.	MEMORY HOOK 'Un' (not) + 'even' (equal) = lacking balance and uniformity.	SYNONYMS • disparate • irregular • inconsistent	ANTONYMS • uniform • equitable • consistent
11	**burden** NOUN NEGATIVE	बोझ / उत्तरदायित्व का भार A heavy load, demanding responsibility, or distressing obligation.	MEMORY HOOK A 'burden' feels like bearing a heavy bag that burns your back.	SYNONYMS • onus • encumbrance • liability	ANTONYMS • relief • advantage • boon

VOCAB LAB CONTINUED · META'S US DEAL REDRAWS LINE OF ACCOUNTABILITY · PART 02

ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTIONS · 3 TERMS

01	**infinite scroll** NOUN	अंतहीन स्क्रॉलिंग प्रणाली A web-design technique that loads content continuously as the user scrolls down.	MEMORY HOOK 'Infinite' means endless; continuously rolling a parchment without reaching the end.	SYNONYMS • continuous scrolling • perpetual feed • endless pagination	ANTONYMS • paginated interface • finite layout • page break
02	**commodity** NOUN	पण्य वस्तु / व्यापारिक उत्पाद A raw material, product, or service that can be bought, sold, or traded.	MEMORY HOOK 'Common' goods bought and sold in quantity are known as commodities.	SYNONYMS • merchandise • product • good	ANTONYMS • intangible • non-commercial item • unmarketable asset
03	**disengagement** NOUN	अलगाव / अलग होने की प्रक्रिया The act or process of withdrawing from an involvement, platform, or relationship.	MEMORY HOOK 'Dis' (removal) + 'engagement' (involvement) = breaking free from an attachment.	SYNONYMS • detachment • withdrawal • disconnection	ANTONYMS • involvement • absorption • engagement

FIXED PREPOSITIONS · 2 TERMS

01	**responsibility towards** PHRASE	के प्रति उत्तरदायित्व Having an ethical or legal obligation of care aimed at a specific entity.	MEMORY HOOK Directing one's 'response' and duty 'towards' a target group or obligation.	SYNONYMS • accountability to • obligation to • duty to	ANTONYMS • unaccountability to • disregard for • negligence of
02	**reliant solely on** PHRASE	पूरी तरह से पर निर्भर Exclusively dependent on a single source or mechanism for support or function.	MEMORY HOOK 'Rely on' means to depend upon; adding 'solely' restricts it entirely to one pillar.	SYNONYMS • dependent solely on • contingent exclusively up • resting entirely on	ANTONYMS • independent of • unreliant on • autonomous from

PHRASAL VERBS · 3 TERMS

01	**moving towards** PHRASAL VERB	की दिशा में आगे बढ़ना Progressing or shifting in the direction of a specific goal or state.	MEMORY HOOK 'Moving' step-by-step 'towards' a designated target.	SYNONYMS • progressing to • gravitating towards • advancing to	ANTONYMS • retreating from • diverging from • regressing from
02	**pushed towards** PHRASAL VERB	की ओर धकेलना / थोपना Transferred an onerous burden or responsibility onto another party.	MEMORY HOOK 'Pushing' a heavy load 'towards' someone else to avoid carrying it yourself.	SYNONYMS • shunted onto • offloaded onto • deflected towards	ANTONYMS • shouldered • assumed • absorbed
03	**opt out of** PHRASAL VERB	से बाहर निकलने का विकल्प चुनना To choose formally not to participate in or be included in an activity or system.	MEMORY HOOK Make an 'option' to go 'out' of a scheme.	SYNONYMS • decline • withdraw from • renege on	ANTONYMS • opt into • subscribe to • participate in

IDIOMS & PHRASES · 3 TERMS

01	**leaves untouched** PHRASE	अनछुआ छोड़ देना / अनदेखा करना Fails to address, alter, or resolve a fundamental issue.	MEMORY HOOK If your hands never 'touch' a chore, it remains completely unaddressed.	SYNONYMS • bypasses • overlooks • neglects	ANTONYMS • addresses • confronts • remedies
02	**move responsibility upstream** PHRASE	जिम्मेदारी को मूल स्रोत पर स्थानांतरित करना Shifting accountability to the original creators and structural source of a problem.	MEMORY HOOK Fixing river pollution at the 'upstream' spring rather than downstream at the mouth.	SYNONYMS • address root causes • shift accountability to sou • fix origin	ANTONYMS • shift blame downstream • pass the buck • target symptoms
03	**redraw the boundaries of** PHRASE	की सीमाओं को पुनर्परिभाषित करना To fundamentally revise and redefine the established limits, scope, or terms of something.	MEMORY HOOK Erasing old borders on a map to 'redraw' modern, fairer boundary lines.	SYNONYMS • redefine the limits of • restructure the scope of • reframe the terms of	ANTONYMS • maintain the status quo of • preserve the boundaries of • entrench the limits of

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TODAY'S EDITORIALS

ONE STEP AHEAD EVERYDAY ★

📅 AUGUST 31, 2026

THANK YOU!

FOR READING. FOR LEARNING.
FOR GROWING EVERY DAY.

We're really thrilled to keep working on this. We hope you'll continue supporting this effort until the very end. Most importantly, we hope each one of you achieves success and gets selected in your recruitment exam. ❤️📚✨

If you put in the necessary effort and stay consistent, your ambition of building a career in the public or private sector can certainly become a reality.

> Just keep in mind one thing,
> ***"A reader lives a thousand lives before he dies...***
> ***The man who never reads lives only one."***

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INDIAN POLITY
ENVIRONMENT
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☑ Read
☑ Learn
☑ Succeed
THE HINDU

RELEVANT EDITORAILS
Handpicked Daily

VOCABULARY LIST
Multiple Synonyms, Tone & Part of Speech

SMARTER PREPARATION
Better Understanding

STRONGER RESULTS
Achieve Your Goal

KEEP READING. KEEP GROWING. KEEP ACHIEVING. 📚✨